NextIgnition — Cost Comparison

Server hosting · Frontend hosting · AI/LLM costing — basic to medium tiers

Prepared June 2026 · USD unless noted · vendor prices change — verify before relying

This compares the services NextIgnition actually uses, at basic (free/low) and medium (small-production) levels. Goal: keep costs reasonable. Three categories are compared — Server/backend, Frontend hosting, and AI/LLM. Two end-to-end monthly scenarios are given at the end.

1. AI / LLM costing (per 1,000,000 tokens)

Provider / Model (as used in app)	Input $/1M	Output $/1M	Tier	Notes
OpenRouter "openrouter/free" (DEFAULT)	$0.00	$0.00	Basic	Free; 50 req/day (1,000/day after a one-time $10 credit)
Google Gemini 2.5 Flash-Lite	$0.10	$0.40	Basic-Med	Cheapest reliable paid fallback
Google Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	$0.25	$1.50	Medium	GA budget model
Google Gemini 3.5 Flash	$1.50	$9.00	Medium	Latest Flash; higher quality
OpenAI GPT-4 Turbo (useGPT4 = ON)	$10.00	$30.00	High (avoid)	Most expensive path — keep OFF

Recommendation: keep useGPT4 OFF (default free model), buy $10 OpenRouter credit once (50 -> 1,000 free req/day), and use Gemini 2.5 Flash-Lite as the cheap paid fallback. Net recurring AI cost at basic/medium scale: ~ $0/month.

2. Server / backend hosting (per month)

Service	Plan	Cost / mo	Tier	Notes
Render (backend API)	Free	$0	Basic	Spins down after 15 min idle (~1 min cold start)
Render (backend API)	Starter	$7	Medium	Always-on, 512 MB RAM — recommended minimum
Render (backend API)	Standard	$25	Medium+	2 GB RAM for heavier traffic
Supabase (DB + storage + auth)	Free	$0	Basic	Pauses after 7 days idle; 500 MB DB, 1 GB files
Supabase (DB + storage + auth)	Pro	$25	Medium	Always-on, daily backups, 8 GB DB, 100 GB files

DB lives in Supabase, so no separate Render database is needed. Medium backend = Render Starter ($7) + Supabase Pro ($25).

3. Frontend hosting (per month)

Service	Free tier	Paid	Commercial on free?	Notes
Cloudflare Pages	$0 (unlimited bandwidth)	~$5-20	Yes	Best free option for a monetized app
Netlify	$0 (100 GB)	$19	Yes (basic)	Generous free tier
Render Static Site	$0	-	Yes	Keeps everything on one provider
Vercel	$0 (100 GB)	$20 / seat	No	Hobby is non-commercial; needs Pro for a paid app

Tip: a monetized app on Vercel needs Pro ($20). Cloudflare Pages / Render Static are free AND allow commercial use — save $20/mo.

4. Monthly cost scenarios

Component	BASIC (dev / MVP)	MEDIUM (small production)
Backend (Render)	Free ($0)	Starter ($7)
Database/Storage (Supabase)	Free ($0)	Pro ($25)
Frontend hosting	Cloudflare/Vercel Hobby ($0)	Cloudflare Pages ($0)
AI / LLM	OpenRouter free ($0)	OpenRouter free + $10 once (~$0/mo)
Email (Resend)	Free 3k/mo ($0)	Free 3k/mo ($0)
SMS OTP (Twilio)	pay-per-use	pay-per-use (~Rs 0.45/OTP)
Payments (Razorpay)	2% + GST / txn	2% + GST / txn
FIXED MONTHLY TOTAL	~ $0 / month	~ $32 / month

BASIC ~ $0/mo: every service on its free tier — great for development/demo, but Supabase pauses, Render cold-starts, and Vercel Hobby is non-commercial. MEDIUM ~ $32/mo: Supabase Pro ($25) + Render Starter ($7) + free commercial frontend, plus a one-time $10 to OpenRouter. Using Vercel Pro instead of Cloudflare makes it ~ $52/mo. Usage costs (Twilio OTP, Razorpay %) are on top and scale with activity, not a fixed fee.